MODULE 2 · CONTINGENCIES, ACAS II AND PHRASEOLOGY

Lesson 06: Phraseology, Reporting and Crew Knowledge

Lesson 6 of 6 · about 6 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Use the standard RVSM phraseology.
- Complete the post-flight entries and reports.
- Review the RVSM knowledge items required for recurrent training.



Standard phraseology and reporting complete the RVSM picture.

Standard phraseology

Circumstance	Phraseology
ATC asks the RVSM status of a flight	“Confirm RVSM approved.”
Pilot: the flight is RVSM approved	“Affirm RVSM.”
Pilot: the flight is not RVSM approved	“Negative RVSM.”
Pilot of a State aircraft that is not RVSM approved	“Negative RVSM, State aircraft.”
ATC denies entry to RVSM airspace	“Unable clearance into RVSM airspace, maintain (or descend to, or climb to) flight level ...”
Pilot: weather prevents height-keeping (e.g. severe turbulence)	“Unable RVSM due turbulence.”
Pilot: equipment degraded below RVSM requirements	“Unable RVSM due equipment.”

ATC asks to be told when RVSM can be resumed	“Report able to resume RVSM.”
Pilot: able to resume after a contingency	“Ready to resume RVSM.”

After the flight

- Enter in the technical log any problem with altitude-keeping, transponder failures, or altimeter differences greater than **200 ft**.
- File the **altitude deviation report** for any deviation of **300 ft or more** from the cleared level.
- File the **wake turbulence encounter report** after any significant wake encounter.

What every crew member must know (recurrent training items)

1. Airworthiness documents and the aircraft's RVSM approval;
2. operating practices and procedures, the Operations Manual and checklists;
3. the MEL items for RVSM;
4. standard ATC phraseology and cross-checking of clearances;
5. use of the standby altimeter in contingencies;
6. problems of visual perception of other aircraft only 1,000 ft away;
7. characteristics of the altitude capture system;
8. the relationship between altimetry, automatic altitude control and transponder in normal and abnormal conditions;
9. any airframe operating restrictions for RVSM.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Know the standard phrases: Affirm / Negative RVSM, Unable RVSM due turbulence / equipment, Ready to resume RVSM.
- Technical log: altimeter differences over 200 ft, altitude-keeping or transponder problems.
- Report altitude deviations of 300 ft or more, and wake turbulence encounters.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

ATC asks “Confirm RVSM approved”. Your aircraft is approved. What do you reply?

A. “Roger”

B. “Affirm RVSM”

C. “Wilco RVSM”

D. “RVSM capable”

Answer: B. The standard reply is “Affirm RVSM”.

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.